

Thato Mapheto

Finance & Accounting Professional | Cost Control & Financial Governance | Data Analytics

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PROFILE

Finance professional with 2+ years' experience in cost control, financial governance, and month-end close within a heavy-industrial SAP environment, including a track record of identifying and recovering material budget variances. This is complemented by ongoing independent contract work in audit and financial reconciliation across large multi-billion-rand projects. Since 2025, I have completed a focused programme of study in renewable energy finance (Renewable Energy specialization), DLO/EWSETA project finance modelling) and modern financial analyst tools (Coursera AI, Excel & Power BI; Python; SQL), applied through self-directed Python FP&A modelling projects and live client reconciliation engagements. Looking to bring proven cost-accounting fundamentals together with this newer analytical, audit, and clean-energy finance skill set in a junior accountant or finance/financial analyst role.

EDUCATION

BCom Accounting

University of Johannesburg

Feb 2019 – Nov 2021

EXPERIENCE

Audit & Financial Reconciliation Consultant (Contract) Apr 2025 – Present

Mieke Projects (Pty) Ltd

- Conducted a full compliance audit of 600+ employee records across multiple large-scale projects, verifying employment contracts, identification documents, qualifications, and proof of residence against company records.
- Produced detailed audit reports identifying missing, incomplete, and inconsistent documentation, with findings and corrective recommendations for management.
- Reconciled project and supplier expenditure exceeding R1 billion between internal project records and ERP systems, investigating and resolving material variances.
- Performed invoice validation across large supplier populations, identifying duplicate invoices, missing invoices, incorrect invoice values, VAT discrepancies, and local content inconsistencies.
- Traced supporting documentation to resolve discrepancies, corrected supplier records, and documented all reconciliation adjustments with clear, auditable trails.
- Prepared comprehensive Excel reconciliation schedules and management reports summarising findings, outstanding issues, and recommended corrective actions.
- Worked independently across multiple concurrent client engagements, managing competing deadlines while maintaining high standards of accuracy and data integrity.

Acting Finance Supervisor

Sibanye Stillwater | Rustenburg, South Africa

Dec 2023 – Jan 2024

- Led day-to-day finance operations across multiple cost centres, stepping up from Finance Graduate to cover supervisory responsibilities.
- Acted as key liaison between finance, procurement, payroll, and operations teams to resolve queries and keep cost reporting on schedule.
- Ensured adherence to governance frameworks, company policy, and accurate SAP processing across the team.
- Provided guidance on budgeting, invoice validation, and cost reporting to operational stakeholders.

Finance Graduate

Sibanye Stillwater | Rustenburg, South Africa

2022 – Jul 2024

- Identified and recovered approximately R11 million in incorrectly parked and aged SAP commitments, improving budget availability and cost-centre accuracy.
- Performed detailed cost and variance analysis against approved business plans, enabling corrective action at operational level.
- Monitored CAPEX, inventory, and materials costs through reconciliations, cycle counts, and expediting reports.
- Supported month-end close through accruals, provisions, cost transfers, and trial balance clean-up.

- Validated invoices for VAT accuracy, contractual alignment, and labour costing to strengthen compliance.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT (AUG 2025 – JUN 2026)

Completed a sustained, self-funded programme of study covering renewable energy finance and modern financial-analyst tooling:

- Data Science — ALX Africa, completed Jun 2026.
- Financial Analyst: AI, Excel, and Power BI Skills (Professional Certificate, 6 courses) — Coursera, May 2026.
- Python Programming (8-week) — ALX Africa, completed Feb 2026.
- Renewable Energy Specialization (4 courses: Technology Fundamentals, Power & Electricity Systems, Projects, Futures) — University of Colorado Boulder / Coursera, completed Feb 2026.
- Project Finance and Renewable Energy Financial Modelling — DLO Academy / EWSETA, Jan 2026.
- Data Analytics Certificate — ALX Africa, Dec 2025.
- Renewable Energy Projects — University of Colorado Boulder / Coursera, Dec 2025.
- Professional Foundations Certificate — ALX Africa, Aug 2025.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

Self-directed projects built to apply certifications in practice and develop a freelance/consulting portfolio:

- NimbusX FP&A Framework (2025 – 2026): built full Python-based financial planning & analysis models for two case-study organisations — a renewable energy business and an NPO childcare operator — as portfolio pieces for freelance and job applications. Modules covered revenue modelling, working capital, CAPEX, funding, Monte Carlo simulation, sensitivity/tornado analysis, DCF valuation, and automated reporting.
- Procurement & Financial Dashboard (Dec 2025 – present): designed an end-to-end SQL and Power BI dashboard analysing spend, supplier performance, and cost drivers, with a relational database structure supporting interactive reporting.

SKILLS

Finance & Cost Control: Management accounting, budgeting & forecasting, cost & variance analysis, CAPEX tracking, AFE tracking, P&L and balance sheet analysis, VAT & compliance review, month-end close

Audit & Reconciliation: Invoice validation, duplicate/missing invoice detection, VAT and local content compliance, multi-ERP reconciliation (SAP, Trimax), documentation and compliance auditing, variance investigation, audit trail documentation, management reporting

Data & Analytics: SQL, Power BI, DAX basics, data cleaning & preparation, exploratory data analysis, relational database design, dashboards & data visualisation

Systems & Tools: SAP ERP, Trimax ERP, Microsoft Excel (pivot tables, lookups, large-scale reconciliations), budget uploads, Google Workspace

Professional: Stakeholder communication, cross-functional collaboration, attention to detail, problem solving, adaptability, time management, independent client management

REFERENCES

Available on request